Christ in You, the Hope of Glory

Paul rejoices to suffer for the Church and serves as its steward to make known God's long-hidden mystery — "Christ in you, the hope of glory" — laboring in Christ's power to present every believer mature in Christ.

Where this study fits

Colossians · twelve studies · this study highlighted

01 1:1–8 **Faith, Love, and Hope in Colossae**	**02 1:9–14** **Paul’s Prayer for the Colossians**	**03 1:15–23** **The Savior of the Gospel**	**04 1:24–29** **Christ in You, the Hope of Glory**
05 2:1–7 **The Believer’s Education**	**06 2:8–15** **Beware of Philosophy**	**07 2:16–23** **Run the Race Set Before You**	**08 3:1–11** **Looking Up, Putting Off**
09 3:12–17 **Service Manual for the Lord’s Army**	**10 3:18–4:1** **The Relationships of the New Man**	**11 4:2–6** **Perfecting the Prayer Life**	**12 4:7–18** **Portrait of a Ministry Team**

Four movements of the mystery

Colossians 1:24–29 · The commentary's outline

I. The suffering	II. The stewardship	III. The secret	IV. The success
θλῖψις Paul rejoices to bear afflictions for Christ's body, the Church	**οἰκονομία** As God's steward he makes known what was hidden for ages	**μυστήριον** "Christ in you, the hope of glory" — even among Gentiles	**τέλειος** Presenting every believer complete in Christ
v.24	vv.25–26	v.27	vv.28–29

The false teachers offered mysteries for the few. God has revealed His mystery to all His saints — the indwelling Christ.

“Filling up what is lacking”?

Colossians 1:24 · Outline I.B — It is connected to the afflictions of Christ

What is not lacking

The atonement — “It is finished!” (John 19:30)

One offering perfects forever (Heb 10:14)

Thlipsis is never used in the NT of Christ’s atoning sufferings

vs

What Paul fills up
θλῖψις · ἀνταναπληρόω

Distress from outward circumstances (BDAG) — the trials of life

His share of the afflictions Christ’s body bears in serving Him

“Saul, why are you persecuting Me?” (Acts 9:4) — the Head feels the body’s pain

Every believer strengthened by this letter is a beneficiary of Paul’s chains.

What the mystery is — and is not

Colossians 1:26–27 · Outline II.B and III — Hidden, now manifested

× Not simply Gentile salvation

Promised as early as Genesis 12:3 — all the families of the earth blessed through Abraham's seed

1 Jew and Gentile in one body

On the same level, in one body (Eph 3:3–6)

2 The indwelling Christ

"Christ in you"
The Messiah living in His people (Col 1:26–27)

3 The Church as the bride

Christ and the Church (Eph 5:32)

4 The rapture of the Church

"We will not all sleep" (1 Cor 15:51–52)

? A biblical mystery

μυστήριον
Not a puzzle for the clever — truth unknowable until God revealed it

“Christ in you, the hope of glory”

Colossians 1:27 · Outline III.A–C — The secret of the mystery

1	**God willed to reveal it** Revelation is progressive; through Paul and the apostles God gave the revelation for the Church age	**πλοῦτος** riches of the glory
2	**The Gentiles received it** Paul, apostle to the Gentiles (Rom 11:13); Peter first opened the door at Cornelius’s house (Acts 10–11)	**“among the Gentiles”**
3	**Christ in you defines it** The Messiah does not merely stand beside His people — He lives in them, as no Old Testament saint experienced	**the heart** of the mystery
4	**The hope of glory** Not the hope of heaven — settled at faith (1:13–14) — but of sharing Christ’s glory when He is revealed (3:4)	**δόξα** Heb. kavod

The goal, the means and the method

Colossians 1:28–29 · Outline IV — The success of the mystery

Means	“We proclaim Him” — the message is a Person, not a system or a set of rules	**—** v.28a
Means	Admonishing every man — warning wisely; you lead sheep, you cannot drive them	**νουθετέω** to put sense into the mind
Means	Teaching every man with all wisdom — told accurately, explained convincingly, applied lovingly	**—** v.28b
Goal	Present every man complete in Christ — at the Judgment Seat of Christ	**τέλειος** mature, full-grown — not sinless
Method	Laboring and striving — toil to weariness, an athlete’s strain	**κοπιάω · ἀγωνίζομαι** v.29a
Method	“According to His power, which mightily works within me”	**ἐνέργεια** God supplies the energy — and gets the credit

Discuss and apply

Colossians 1:24–29 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. How can Paul speak of “filling up what is lacking in Christ’s afflictions” without denying the finished work of the cross?

2. According to this study, what does “the hope of glory” refer to, and why does that matter?

Apply

Live Aware of the Indwelling Christ
Set a reminder three times a day this week — “Christ in you” — and pause to thank Him for His presence.

Invest in Someone’s Maturity
Invite one believer to read Colossians with you over the coming weeks.

In one line: God’s secret is out: Christ lives in every believer — and He is leading each one toward maturity and glory.